

Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata

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29 July 2026

Galleries Lafayette — Recruitment Team
Paris

Re: Application for Alternance - Assistant Acheteur en horlogerie F/H (24-month apprenticeship, starting September 2026)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm applying for the Alternance - Assistant Acheteur en horlogerie F/H apprenticeship at Galleries Lafayette in Paris, starting September 2026 for a 24-month contract. I have three years of experience in business development, strategy consulting, and analysis, most recently as a Strategy and Marketing Corporate Consultant Intern at FORVIA, and I'm looking for an apprenticeship in procurement at a company I can stay with long-term.

Galleries Lafayette's position as one of France's most iconic department store groups means its buying teams — including for a specialized category like watches — have to combine genuine product expertise with the commercial negotiation needed to keep a flagship retail assortment both aspirational and profitable.

As a Senior Analyst at GEP Worldwide, I worked directly on procurement: my market research on car fleet sourcing delivered a 6% saving for the client, and I regularly drafted and analyzed RFIs, RFQs, and RFPs from the buyer's side. At FORVIA, I now support Purchasing with competitor and market intelligence for their sourcing decisions. My mechanical engineering background means I can read a technical spec and a commercial term sheet equally well, which helps when cost, quality, and delivery all come up in the same negotiation.

I'm currently completing a Master in Management at ESSEC Business School (ranked #10 globally in the Financial Times' 2025 Masters in Management ranking), with coursework in Strategy and Management, Marketing Management, and People and Organizations. Before that, I did a B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering at the National Institute of Technology Calicut (ranked #21 in India, NIRF 2025), with coursework in Operations Research, Project Management, Supply Chain Management, Quality Planning and Analysis, and Production Systems Management. The engineering degree gives me a technical grounding most business-school candidates don't have, and ESSEC has given me the strategy and commercial side.

I'm available to start in September 2026, and I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I could contribute to your team. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Giridhar Dhananjay Khaza Venkata